



ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION
UNION PANAFRICAINNE DES ETUDIANTS
الاتحاد جميع الطلاب الأفريقي
Defending students rights since 1972



MIGRATION & MOBILITY
WORKING GROUP

DECENT WORK INITIATIVE:

Young people in quality jobs and decent work for a better world



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OVERVIEW OF THE PROJECT

The Youth of Africa represents the resources for the future governance of Africa. Hence, it is important to pay attention to their total development. Unfortunately, their development has been directed to their intellectual development and sometimes neglecting their aspirations in their working life and their rights in the terms of conditions of work safety and remuneration. Some interventions have been introduced to address this, but it seems not to meet the required impact. This has really informed the All-Africa Students Union's (AASU) decision to come up with this concept "Decent Work Initiative" which is meant to achieve a dual purpose, which is identifying talents, giving them the opportunity to showcase it and educating the formal and Informal Sector on the need to employ the young people, give them opportunities for work that are productive, security at the work place, fair income and social protection.

AASU's Decent Work Initiative will be an Inter Africa University Essay competition aimed at raising awareness on the need for employing young people, the need for social integration, equality of opportunity for them, better outlook for their personal development, liberty to express their concerns, arrange and play a part in decisions that affect them.

The ASSU Decent Work Initiative Inter Africa Essay competition will be a yearly event.

Participants will choose a topic of their choice on Decent Work and develop it into an academic publication, a policy brief or an innovative project work. They will be interviewed to present it through an audition. Audition will be in two parts. The first part will be a regional audition where 25 Participants will be selected to represent the Five (5) Regions in Africa. 10 Participants will be selected for the in the second phase of the audition. The 10 Participants will now contest for the Top 5 position. The top five winners will be the ambassadors for the AASU Decent Work Initiative representing the 5 Regions of Africa.

PROJECT DEFINITION

AASU wants to organize a yearly essay competition (Inter African University Essay Competition) for young people between the ages of 20-35years old who are enrolled in a University in Africa. AASU is using this competition to promote the aspirations of young people in their working lives, respect for their employment conditions, quality jobs for them, ensure their rights at the workplace is respected, improve their social dialogue and social security. It is also a vehicle to empower the participants and young people with the necessary tools to go into entrepreneurship, work efficiently, apply for quality jobs, get employment in the formal and informal sector. This project is also a vehicle to enhance education on 'Better Work' for young people in Africa and to blend intellect, passion, unearth talent, get the formal and Informal sector to employ young people, project young people within the continent and create quality job opportunities for them.

OBJECTIVES/AIMS

1. Identify talent within the continent and provide them with an opportunity to showcase it.
2. Inform and educate at least 90% of the population in the African continent on the need for Decent Work for young people.
3. Encourage the formal and Informal sector to get involved in the campaign.
4. An urgent action to create decent jobs for young people in Africa.
5. Dignity, equality and quality job priority for a better world training for young people in Africa.
6. Inter-Country webinars, workshops, conferences on employment investment and development for young people in Universities.
7. Enhance Education on AASU's decent work initiative.
8. Promote decent work amongst young people in Africa.

METHODS

1. Intercommunicate with target participants in their respective countries through the member unions to promote participation and congruity to achieve the AASU's goal for the Decent Work Initiative.
2. Identify participants between the ages of 20 – 35 from selected Universities within Africa.

3. Select participants through auditions.
4. Auditions will take place in selected countries.
5. Participants must submit Decent Work essay to qualify to the next round.
6. Participants must be African by birth, adoption or naturalization.
7. Ten participants will be selected for the grand finale.
8. These participants are expected to undergo a series of face to face/online decent work workshops to equip them with the necessary knowledge they need for the tasks ahead in campaigning for Decent Work for young people within the continent, to stakeholders, the formal and Informal Sector to improve in Decent Work for young people within Africa.
9. They will submit a research publication on the grand finale to be marked by the AASU secretariat.
10. Winner and runner ups will be announced.
11. The winner and runner ups of the AASU Decent Work Initiative will be Ambassadors to promote ASSU Decent Work Initiative for one (1) year.
12. The winner and runner ups will walk home with a prize while the other contestants who failed to make it to the first 3 will be presented with a certificate of participation.
13. A committee will be set up to ensure that the winner and runner ups perform their roles as an AASU Decent Work Initiative ambassador.

Funds committed to the initiative will be used for the Decent Work Initiative campaign as follows:

- AASU Decent Work Initiative ambassadors will serve as agents of change for inequalities and challenges which continue to be major obstacles to the SDG 8's progress within the continent.
- Discourse on Employment Creation (Webinars, conferences, workshops, etc.).
- Circularize the need for Social Protection within the Formal and Informal sector.
- The ambassadors will collaborate and build confidence with stakeholders, formal and Informal sectors within the continent.
- Advocate on the need to respect young people and their Rights at work.
- Give young people in the continent a voice in what they do
- Educate the corporate world on the need for protecting young people from exploitation and a future that is inclusive and sustainable.

BUDGETS COUNTRY AUDITIONS

- 1.** Accommodation for the crew
- 2.** Visa and air tickets for crew
- 3.** Hire of venue, master of ceremony and PA systems
- 4.** Media exposure for the campaign and call for participation
- 5.** Set up cost (Printing of brochures, banners and branding of shirts)
- 6.** Photography

THE FINAL EVENTS

- 1.** Costumes for the participants
- 2.** Accommodation for the crew and participants
- 3.** Venue/Decoration for the grand finale
- 4.** Feeding/Refreshment for the crew and participants
- 5.** Master of Ceremony, Performing Artiste, Invited Guest, Judges
- 6.** Prizes for all contestants
- 7.** Media

MAJOR SPONSOR: Amount involved is

- Brand Exposure
- Sponsorship visit
- Sponsors can draw on contestants for the exposure of their brands.
- AASU will be decorating the venue with sponsor's banners.
- Major Sponsor will get the chance to use any of the contestants for their marketing promotion and activations.
- Major Sponsor will present awards to Participants.
- Logo on T-shirts and other print items (banners, paraphernalia)
- Logo on Certificate of participation and other awards
- Group Photograph with contestants

SUPPORTING SPONSOR: Amount involved is

- Brand Exposure
- Sponsorship visit
- Sponsors can draw on contestants for the exposure of their brands.
- AASU will be decorating the venue with sponsor's banners.
- Major Sponsor will get the chance to use any of the contestants for their marketing promotion and activations.
- Logo on T-shirts and other print items (banners, paraphernalia)
- Logo on Certificate of participation and other awards
- Group Photograph with contestants

DONORS: Amount involved is

- Brand Exposure
- Sponsorship visit
- Sponsors can draw on contestants for the exposure of their brands.
- Logo on Certificate of participation and other awards
- Group Photograph with contestants

MEDIA PARTNERS

MONITORING AND EVALUATION

There will be a monitoring and evaluation committee that will ensure that all activities carried out are in compliance or made towards the said objectives of the AASU DECENT WORK INITIATIVE. This committee will submit a report after every audition and training in the various countries, which will help us in subsequent auditions and trainings in the various countries till the final event. AASU will set standards which is the objective we want to achieve and compare the actual performance against the standard. AASU will identify deviations from the standard and take necessary corrective action for the subsequent yearly event.

SUSTAINABILITY PLAN

AASU in partnership with its key partners will drive the Decent Work Initiative that will be to the far-reaching benefit of young people of the African Continent, this will go a long way to increase youth engagement in national development.

After the Decent Work Initiative programme, awareness would have been created in the minds of organizations, the formal and Informal sectors, individuals, higher learning institutions in Africa and beyond to understand the importance of their contribution to decent work among the youth of Africa and the need to bring to light the extremely diversified employment conditions and decent work issues in their respective countries. A committee will be set up to manage funds contributed by donors to assist with the eradication of indecent work. Part of the funds will be allocated for education of young people in the continent. These young people will be youth ambassadors for Decent Work Initiative.

CONCLUSION

We all owe it as a responsibility to provide fair income, safe working industry, quality jobs and avenues for young people to demonstrate their potential and also build in them the sense of responsibility, environment awareness and achievement. This will go a long way to achieve our collective goal as a corporate Africa.

ABOUT THE ALL-AFRICA STUDENTS UNION

AASU is the largest student movement in Africa and a very dominant force on the Continent and beyond. The All-Africa Students Union (AASU) organizes all students in Africa from the basic level to Institutions of higher learning; in essence, the Union is the umbrella organization for all students of Africa. Since its inception in 1972, AASU now has presence in 54 Countries in Africa. As the Continent's largest students' group, AASU played an important role in the struggle against colonialism and the ending of apartheid. Today, AASU is at the forefront of the fights for equal access to quality education, quality assurance in higher education, harmonization of higher education systems with key emphasis on mobility of students and academics, comparability of qualifications, democratic governance, defending students' rights, promotion of gender and African culture, sustainable development, entrepreneurship, autonomy of higher institutions of learning and the promotion of peace and democratic values.

